Dig Bucks: growth experiment proposal

Nov 4, 2026 · @Matthew

The idea

Give our grease-only customers a secret $20 credit, Dig Bucks, to try the rest of our range during the BFCM mid-sale. We test it properly, with a control group, so we know whether it makes money before we roll it out.

- **Who:** 5,892 customers who bought grease in the last 2 years and nothing else. Another 800 get nothing, so we can compare.
- **What:** $20 off any order of $99 or more on covers, mats and the enclosure. It stacks with the sale prices and free gifts, and only works for the customer it was sent to. It has its own hidden landing page that only these customers are sent to.
- **When:** two emails, Mon 23 Nov (launch) and Mon 30 Nov (expires tomorrow). Ends Tue 1 Dec, 11:59 PM.
- **The ask:** approve the test, the $20 and the product list.

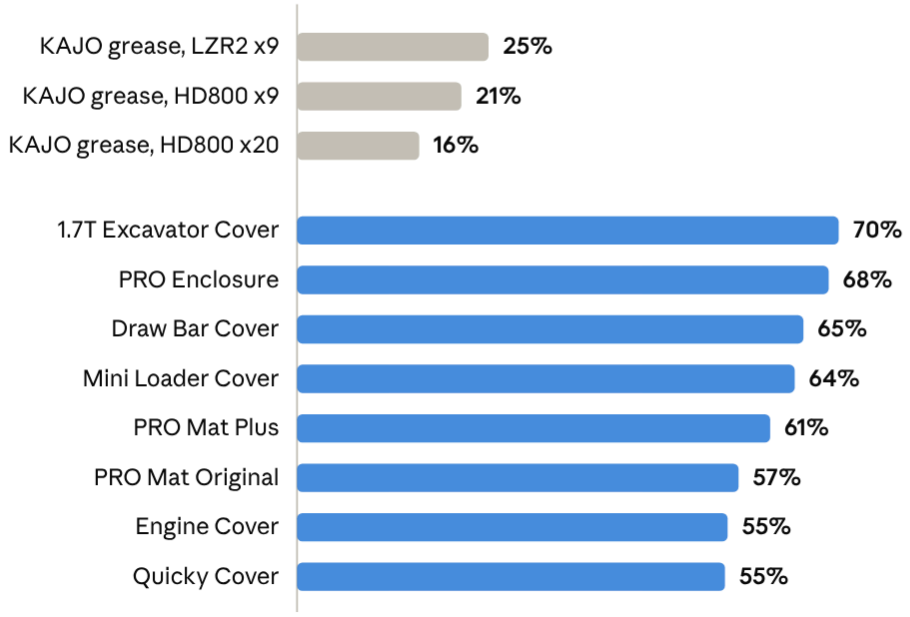
Why it works

A discount on grease would wipe out most of its profit. The same $20 spent on a cover or a mat still leaves a healthy order, so the incentive goes where the margin is.

Grease keeps about 20% of each sale; the gear Dig Bucks buys keeps 55 to 70%

Profit after landed cost and shipping, as a share of net revenue (ex GST, after fees), at full price

Grey = grease. Blue = gear Dig Bucks can be spent on.



INVENTORY_BIBLE_3, COGS - Master · RRP, landed cost, outbound shipping

Where we are today

About 1 in 4 grease customers ever buys anything else from us, and that share hasn't moved in three years. The share who cross-buy in the same year is rising, but most still buy grease and stop.

Bought grease in	Grease customers	Also bought non-grease, same year	Ever bought non-grease
2026 (to 4 Nov)	7,805	1,801 (23%)	2,110 (27%)
2025	4,944	928 (19%)	1,300 (26%)
2024	2,388	416 (17%)	640 (27%)

- **By product:** tube buyers (KAJO Grease Packs) and grease accessory buyers (gun, adapter, couplers) look the same: 27% and 26% have ever bought non-grease.

The numbers we're trying to change

1. **First non-grease order in the test window:** from about 1% (the control group will tell us) to 3% or more. Break-even is 1.2%.
2. **Profit per Dig Bucks order:** at least $60 after the $20 (the model expects about $83).

3. **Longer term:** grease customers who are multi-category, 26% today. Dig Bucks only matters if it moves this.

Source: Shopify customer segments, pulled 4 Nov 2026.

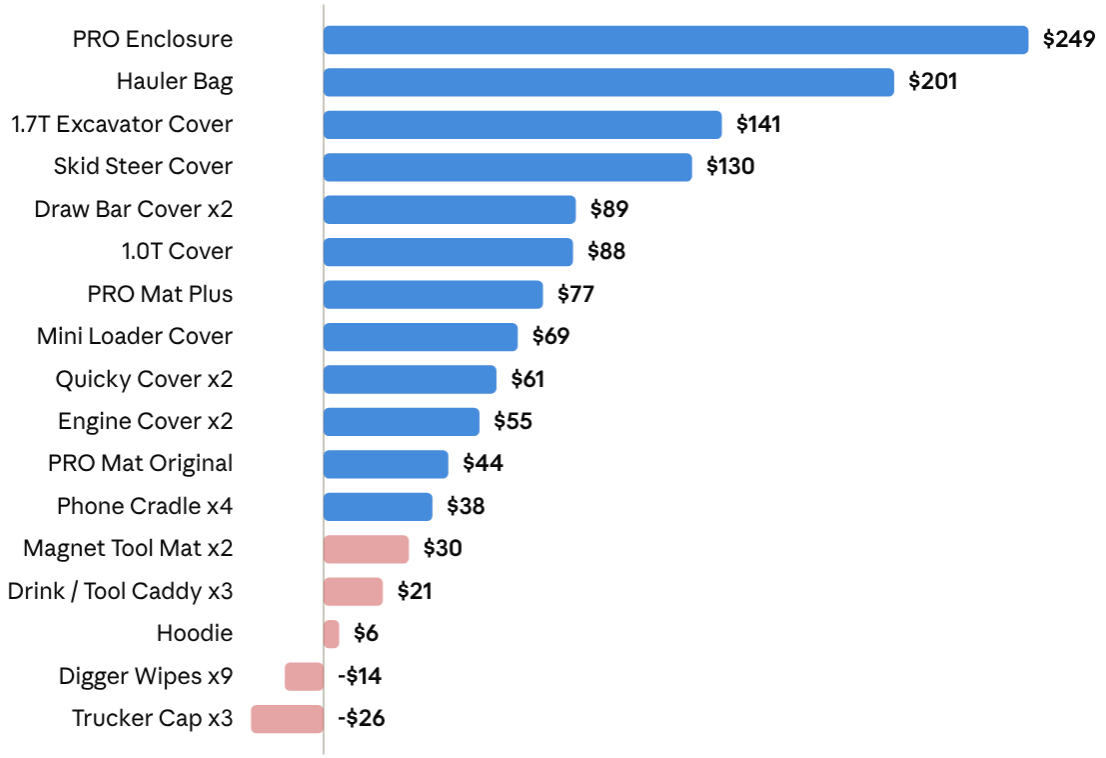
What Dig Bucks can buy

We tested every non-grease product with the sale price, the $20 and the free gifts all stacked. Covers, mats and the enclosure stay well in profit; apparel and small extras don't.

With $20 off, mats and covers still make $38 to $249 an order

Profit per order at sale price with $20 Dig Bucks, smallest basket that reaches $99 (x2 = two units)

Blue = in the Dig Bucks collection. Red = leave out.



INVENTORY_BIBLE_3 costs · 25% sale price, $20 Dig Bucks, $99 minimum, outbound shipping, free-gift cost

- **In:** PRO Enclosure, Hauler Bag, all machine covers, Quicky and Engine Covers, Draw Bar Cover, PRO Mat Plus and Original, Phone Cradle.
- **Out:** apparel, Digger Wipes, cap sets, bottle openers, the Drink / Tool Caddy, bundles, grease, and the Magnet Tool Mat (it's our $599 free gift).
- **Why $99:** a single cover on sale is $86 to $97, so customers add a second item. One Quicky Cover alone would make only $14.

How we'll know it worked

We split the 6,692 customers at random before the sale: 5,892 get Dig Bucks and 800 get nothing. After the sale we compare how many in each group bought non-grease gear. The gap is what Dig Bucks caused.

- **The control group still gets our normal sale emails**, just not the Dig Bucks ones. So we measure the offer, not an extra email.

Decision rule (read on Mon 7 Dec):

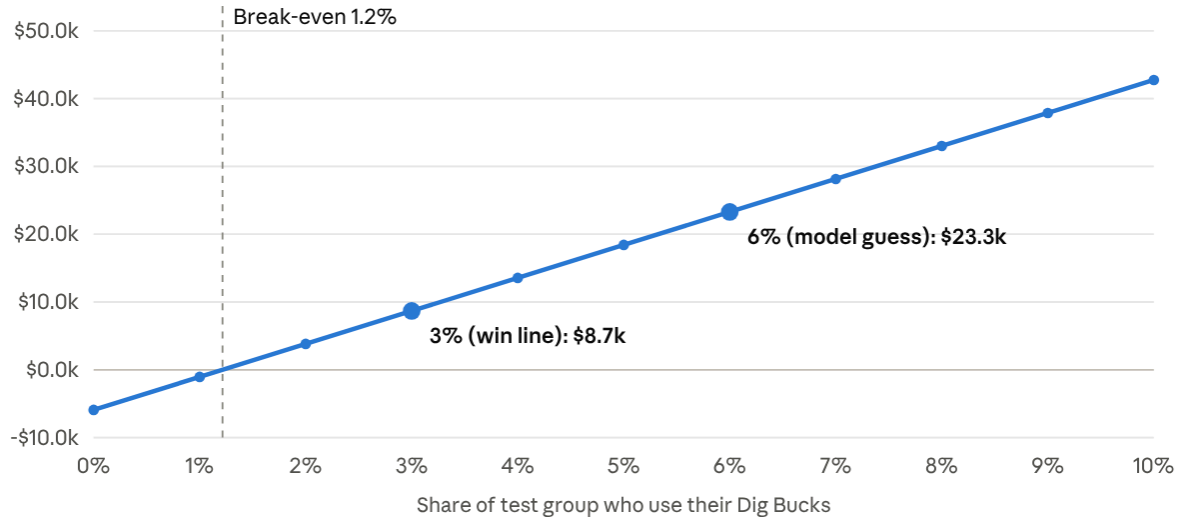
Result: test group vs control	Decision
3% or more buy non-grease, clearly above control	Roll out to all grease-only customers at the next sale
Between break-even (1.2%) and 3%	Run again with $30 or a different product list
Below 1.2%, or no better than control	Stop; Dig Bucks isn't worth the margin

What it could make

At our 3% win line the test adds about $8.7k of profit; at the model's guess of 6% it adds about $23.3k. The downside is capped: if nobody uses it, we've given nothing away.

Dig Bucks pays for itself once 1.2% of the test group use it

Extra profit vs doing nothing, by share of the 5,892 who place a Dig Bucks order. Assumes 1% would buy anyway.



Dig Bucks model · $83 profit per Dig Bucks order, $100 without, 1% baseline (assumption)

- **The worst case is small.** If use comes in at 1% (no better than normal), we lose about $1.0k of margin on people who would have bought anyway.

Plan and deliverables

Need to discuss details.

Risks

Risk	What we do
Our 1% "would buy anyway" guess is wrong	The control group measures the real number; the decision uses that, not the guess
$20 pushes a cart under a free-gift tier	Check in a test checkout before launch and decide which comes first
A one-off sale bump, not a lasting change	Track repeat non-grease orders from both groups through the March quarter